13.8.1 Problems of Women Entrepreneurs

Various problems faced by Indian women who strive hard to become entrepreneur are as follows;

13.8.1.1 Financial Problems

Obtaining support of bankers, managing working capital, lack of credit resources are the problems which remain in the male domain.

13.8.1.2 Shortage of Raw Materials

They encounter problems of shortage of raw materials. This is due to inadequate facilities.

13.8.1.3 Credit Facilities

Women are often denied credit by bankers on the ground of collateral security. So women's access to risk capital is limited.

13.8.1.4 Marketing Problems

Women entrepreneurs face the problems in marketing their products. This area is mainly dominated by males. The elimination of middlemen is difficult and the women entrepreneurs are unable to capture the market and make their products popular.

13.8.1.5 High Cost of Production

High cost of production brings down the efficiency and stands in the way of development and expansion of women's enterprises. The problems faced are labour, human resources, infrastructure, legal formalities, overload of work, lack of family support etc.

13.8.1.6 Social Barriers

Women are seen with suspicious eyes, Particularly, in rural areas they face this problem. The issues related to caste and religion also influence the opportunities for women entrepreneurs.

13.8.1.7 High Competition

Most of the women enterprises have imperfect organizational set up. They are facing severe competitions from organized industries.

13.8.1.8 Lack of Information

Women entrepreneurs lack knowledge and information about the availability of raw materials, financial facilities, government schemes and various kinds of subsidies available. This hinders the expansion of their markets.

13.8.1.9 Lack of Self-Confidence

Due to lack of self-confidence, they hesitate to take risks. Their risk bearing capacity is less. Not only women entrepreneur but also the men entrepreneur face certain problems in initiating and running the business on their own. For overcoming such obstacles one has to attend the entrepreneurial developmental programmes for obtaining appropriate training.

13.9 Entrepreneurial Development Programme (EDP)

Success of an entrepreneurship depends on the foresight, knowledge, optimum hard work, persistence and efficient management. The knowledge about various aspects of business can be acquired from the entrepreneurial development programme. The government plays a positive role in the emergence and development of entrepreneurship by providing training, incentives and concessions.

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